

Everyone says trust is earned. But what if you've been thinking about it backwards?

****Platform:**** LinkedIn | ****Target:**** 150-300 words | ****Status:**** DRAFT

Most teams run on a trust-as-currency model: People prove themselves first. Gradually you increase their responsibility. It feels safe because you control when trust gets granted.

But here is what happens: People stop taking ownership. They ask permission instead of making decisions. They bottle up feedback. They wait for instructions instead of thinking independently.

The cost is invisible until you measure it.

****Give trust first.**** Not blind trust. Just a baseline assumption that people are capable and well-intentioned. Then withdraw trust only when specific behaviors warrant it.

You manage the behavior, not the person. One says "you are broken, fix it." The other says "here is what I need to see going forward." Both create accountability. Only one makes people want to stay.

And when you do withdraw trust in a specific area, you name it out loud. Not "I don't trust you with this." Something like: "I trust your judgment on X. What I need to see change is Y." Specific. Behavioral. Something they can actually act on.

What if your "trust but verify" model is actually the thing holding your team back?

Tags

#leadership #teamculture #leadershipdevelopment #trustmatters